

NHANES Dataset Description

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2026-09-30

Introduction

This report describes the unweighted characteristics of 29,400 participants from three cycles of the National Health and Nutrition Examination Survey (NHANES) (Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, n.d.). The tables compare sample size, gender, ethnicity, and average systolic blood pressure across cycles.

Sample size and gender

Table 1 shows the number of participants and the number and percentage of males in each survey cycle.

Table 1: Sample size and male participants by NHANES survey cycle

Survey cycle	Total, n	Males, n (%)
2013–2014	10,175	5,003 (49.2%)
2015–2016	9,971	4,892 (49.1%)
2017–2018	9,254	4,557 (49.2%)

Note:

Unweighted counts; percentages use all participants in each cycle.

Across the three cycles, the dataset contains 29,400 participants. The percentage of males ranges from 49.1% to 49.2%.

Ethnicity

Table 2 presents the number and percentage of participants in each ethnicity category, within each survey cycle.

Table 2: Ethnicity of NHANES participants by survey cycle

Ethnicity	Survey cycle: n (%)		
	2013–2014	2015–2016	2017–2018
Asian	1,074 (10.6%)	1,042 (10.5%)	1,168 (12.6%)
Black	2,267 (22.3%)	2,129 (21.4%)	2,115 (22.9%)
Mexican	1,730 (17.0%)	1,921 (19.3%)	1,367 (14.8%)
Other	470 (4.6%)	505 (5.1%)	634 (6.9%)
Other Hispanic	960 (9.4%)	1,308 (13.1%)	820 (8.9%)
White	3,674 (36.1%)	3,066 (30.7%)	3,150 (34.0%)

Note:

Unweighted counts; percentages are within each survey cycle.

The White category accounts for between 30.7% and 36.1% of participants across the three cycles.

Average systolic blood pressure

Each participant’s average systolic blood pressure (SBP) is calculated from their available readings. Table 3 summarizes these averages by survey cycle.

Table 3: Average systolic blood pressure by NHANES survey cycle

Survey cycle	n	Average SBP (mm Hg)				
		Minimum	Maximum	Median	Mean	SD
2013–2014	7,528	64.7	228.7	115.3	118.3	18.1
2015–2016	7,363	74.0	231.3	117.3	120.4	18.4
2017–2018	6,713	72.7	234.0	118.0	121.7	20.3

Note:

n = participants with at least one SBP reading; SD = standard deviation.

Statistics describe participants’ average SBP.

Mean average SBP ranges from 118.3 to 121.7 mm Hg across the three cycles. Participants without any SBP readings are excluded from these summaries.

References

Centers for Disease Control and Prevention. n.d. *National Health and Nutrition Examination Survey Data*. National Center for Health Statistics. <https://wwwn.cdc.gov/nchs/nhanes/default.aspx>.